

PREPOSITIONS

Preposition is a very important part of speech. Certain words take a certain preposition to convey a certain sense. Prepositions carry little meaning in themselves. Words followed by inappropriate prepositions not only often wreck a sentence but also change its meaning. A Preposition, therefore, is an important word used with a noun or noun equivalent to show its relation with some other word in the sentence.

Some Important Distinctions in the Use of Certain Prepositions

1. **In** - 'In' is generally used before the names of countries and large cities, or before the name of the place in which one is at the time of speaking *e.g.* in a country, in town, in a street ; as,
He settled in Ludhiana.
He was educated in London.
2. **At** - 'At' is used when there is a small extent of space or time. When we refer to small towns or villages, we use 'at'. 'At' means inside, just outside or just beside the building.
3. **In, Into** - 'In' denotes position of rest inside something ; while 'into' denotes motion or direction towards the inside of something.

For Examples :

Ram went **into** the room.

He ran **into** the room.

Water **in** the well is dirty.

4. **On, At, In (for time):**

On is used with the days of the week or month : *as*, On Sunday, On March 28, On Friday.

At is used with exact time : *as*, at five, at sunset, at midnight.

In is used with a period of time, *as*, in the evening, in the morning, in winter, in 1978.

For Example :

She came on Monday.

I go to college at ten.

She takes rest in the evening.

5. **'To', 'Till' (Until)** - These are both used for time.

For example :

She is busy from six to eight.

She worked till twelve.

6. **To, At (Movement) :**

To is used to express motion from one place to another.

At expresses place or position.

For example :

We go to office every day.

Ritu is standing at the door.

Why are you standing at the gate?

7. **For, At (Price):**

For is used if the actual amount is given.

At is used if the actual amount is not given.

For example :

I bought the book for Rs.5/-.

I bought the book at a low price.

8. **For, Since, From (Time):**

For shows a period of time : *as*, for four years, for three months, for a few hours.

Since is used with a point of time at which an action started, and the action is then considered to continue to the time of speaking.

For example :

Nitu has been here for five years.

Nitu has been here since four o' clock.

From can be used for place and time both. When denoting a point of time, it must be followed by 'to' or 'till', *as* :

She has been busy from morning till evening.

You are allowed to attend the college from today.

9. **Beside, Besides** - **Beside** means 'at' or 'by the side of', **Besides** means 'in addition to'.

My college is beside the river.

Besides books, she was given fee concession.

10. **Between, Among :**

Between is used for two persons or two things only.

Among is used for more than two.

For example :

This is between you and me.

Distribute these books among the students.

11. For, During (Time) :

For is used for a period of time definite in length. It shows that the action continues for the whole time or period.

During : Its action can either last the whole period or occur at sometime within the period.

For example :

He worked for a long time.

I was ill for a week and during the period I ate nothing.

12. With, By - With relates to instrument and **'By'** to the agent or the doer; as,

She beat the baby with a stick.

This book has been written by Mr. Lal.

13. In, After (Time):

'In', shows the close of some future period, while **'after'** relates to the past.

For example :

I shall return in a month.

I returned from Mumbai after a week.

14. On, Upon :

On is generally used in speaking of things at rest, while **'upon'** is used to speak of things in motion or action.as,

For example :

The pen is on the table.

The cat jumped upon the wall.

15. In, Within :

In denotes the close or end of some period, while **'within'** denotes some time short of the close.

For example :

I shall return in two days. (at the end of two days)

I shall return within two days (before the end of two days)

16. After and Afterwards :

After is a preposition and must be followed by a noun or a noun equivalent.

Afterwards is an adverb that is used when there is no noun or noun equivalent.

For example :

I left after saying 'good evening'.

I went to college and afterwards had lunch at home.

Appropriate Use of Prepositions

A

Kindly abide <i>by</i> the discipline of our school.	(keep to)
He has been advised to abstain <i>from</i> alcohol.	(keep away)
I am not afraid <i>of</i> him.	(no fear of)
He acceded <i>to</i> my request.	(agreed)
He is ashamed <i>of</i> <i>his</i> conduct.	(sorry for)
You must account for your long absence <i>from</i> the office.	(explain the cause of)
Every man is accountable to God <i>for</i> what he does.	(responsible)
He was accused <i>of</i> theft.	(charged with)
He was acquitted <i>of</i> the charge of the theft.	(declared not guilty)
The watchman is addicted <i>to</i> opium and smoking.	(given)
It was decided to adjourn the meeting <i>to</i> Sunday.	(postpone)
The meeting was adjourned <i>for</i> two days.	(postponed)
Our school is adjacent <i>to</i> our house.	(just near)
He agreed <i>to</i> my proposal.	(accepted)
I cannot agree with you <i>on</i> this issue.	(be of one opinion)
He was alarmed <i>at</i> the news.	(full of fear)
All were amazed <i>at</i> his unexpected success.	(surprised)
Your speech amounts <i>to</i> an insult <i>to</i> us.	(is)
He was angry <i>with</i> me <i>at</i> my attitude.	(displeased)
I am answerable <i>to</i> none for my conduct.	(responsible)
His father is anxious <i>about</i> his success.	(worried)
I have no appetite <i>for</i> food.	(hunger)
I approve of your suggestion.	(accept as correct)
He is not attentive <i>to</i> your lecture.	(listening carefully)
Attend <i>to</i> what I say.	(pay attention to)
He failed to avail himself <i>of</i> the chance.	(take advantage of)
He was not aware <i>of</i> the plot against him.	(conscious)

B

Poverty is no bar <i>to</i> greatness.	(obstacle)
She begged a favour <i>of</i> me.	(asked for)
I bear <i>out</i> his statement.	(confirm)
I can no longer bear <i>with</i> his rudeness.	(tolerate)
He is bent <i>upon</i> (or <i>on</i>) doing mischief.	(firm)

He was born <i>to</i> rich parents.	
He was born <i>in</i> a rich family.	
Beware <i>of</i> that dangerous fellow.	(take heed)
He is blind <i>of</i> one eye.	(unable to see)
He is blind <i>to</i> his shortcomings.	
His health broke <i>down</i> due to overwork.	(collapsed)
I have broken <i>with</i> him for political reason.	(to cut off connection)
The thief broke into the house at the dead of night.	(to enter by force)
Cholera has broken <i>out</i> in the city.	(spread)
The meeting broke <i>up</i> at 9 p.m.	(dispersed)
He is busy <i>with</i> his work.	
He is busy <i>in</i> learning his lesson.	

C

We shall call <i>at</i> his place on Sunday.	(visit)
We have decided to call <i>on</i> the Principal tomorrow at 6 a.m.	(go to see)
The labourers have called <i>off</i> the strike.	(to withdraw)
I was carried <i>away</i> by her beauty.	(to be influenced by)
Ram Murti was charged <i>with</i> theft.	(accused of)
My school is close <i>to</i> my house.	(just near)
Your teacher feels much concerned <i>at</i> your failure.	(sorry for)
How did you come <i>by</i> this camera?	(get)
Our annual examination comes <i>off</i> in April.	(takes place)
Santosh comes <i>of</i> a noble family.	(belongs to)
I came <i>across</i> a beggar in the street.	(saw)
I am rather concerned <i>for</i> his health.	(anxious)
I have no concern in this matter.	(interest)
I have come to condole <i>with</i> my friend <i>upon</i> the death of his mother.	(express sympathy)
A degree was conferred <i>on</i> him.	(granted to)
The building consists <i>of</i> ten rooms.	(is made up of)
He was convicted <i>of</i> theft.	(charged with)
I count upon you <i>for</i> help.	(rely)
She is deaf <i>to</i> all our requests.	(does not listen to)

D, E, F

He deals <i>in</i> sugar.	(trades)
Never deal roughly <i>with</i> your younger.	(behave)
He demanded an explanation <i>from</i> me.	(asked for)
He died <i>of</i> cholera.	(died because of)
I would like to dispose <i>of</i> this case first.	(finish)
Distinguish right <i>from</i> wrong.	(explain the difference)
You may try to distinguish <i>between</i> the two cases.	

You are eligible <i>for</i> this post.	(qualified)
She excels everybody <i>in</i> music.	(beats, is superior to)
He has been expelled <i>from</i> the college.	(turned out)
We are familiar <i>with</i> his tricks. His name is familiar <i>to</i> us.	
The scheme fell <i>through</i> for want <i>of</i> funds.	(fail)
Friends fall <i>off</i> in adversity.	(to become fewer)
He is fond <i>of</i> reading novels.	(interested in)

G, H, I, J, K

He has got <i>into</i> serious troubles.	(to be involved)
My brother has got <i>through</i> the examination.	(to pass)
I get <i>up</i> at four in the morning.	
I am grateful to you <i>for</i> your help.	
He has given <i>up</i> smoking.	(to stop)
The gun did not go <i>off</i> .	(to explode)
The light will soon go <i>out</i> .	(be extinguished)
He hurled a shoe <i>at</i> the speaker.	(threw)
The train was held <i>up</i> near the bridge.	(stopped)
Always hope <i>for</i> the best.	
I have no hope <i>of</i> success.	
I am ignorant <i>of</i> the consequences.	(unaware)
I enquired <i>of</i> him about his residence.	(asked)
Smoking is injurious <i>to</i> health.	(harmful)
Hard work is a key <i>to</i> success.	(leads to)
Keep an eye <i>on</i> him in my absence.	(watch)
Who is knocking at the door?	(striking at)
He knocked him <i>down</i> with one blow.	(threw)

L, M, N, O

He lacks <i>in</i> common sense.	(wants, is short in)
She is laid <i>up with</i> fever today.	(confined to bed)
He lives <i>at</i> Phillaur in Ludhiana.	(a place)
She lives <i>on</i> milk only.	(takes)
Live <i>by</i> honest means.	(use)
Please look <i>into</i> the matter.	(enquire)
Parents look <i>after</i> their children.	(take care of)
I am looking <i>for</i> my missing dog.	(searching)
Look <i>up</i> this word in the dictionary.	(search for)
I look <i>upon</i> him as my uncle.	(regard)
I could make <i>out</i> nothing from his letter.	(understood)
I have made <i>up</i> my deficiency in English.	(compensated)
He is notorious <i>for</i> drinking.	(infamous)

He is obliged to you *for* your help. (grateful)
 Be obedient *to* your elders. (obey)

P, Q, R, S

I cannot part *with* this money. (give up)
 I cannot part *from* my beloved. (to be separated)
 He likes to play *at* cards.
 She fell a prey *to* his tricks. (victim)
 Grief is preying *upon* her mind. (consume)
 He is proficient *in* English. (good at)
 I was prompted *by* noble ideals. (inspired)
 I cannot put *up with* this insult. (tolerate)
 Do not put *off* till tomorrow what you can do today. (postpone)
 Do not quarrel *with* your friend over a trifle.
 He is ready *for* departure.
 He recovered *from* his illness. (got well)
 You must refrain *from* such activities. (avoid)
 He can safely rely *on* (or *upon*) my word. (depend)
 Do not run *after* material comforts. (pursue)
 His health has run *down*. (gone worse)
 I am now sick *of* this routine. (tired)
 He has set *up* a new factory. (started business)
 Winter has set *in*. (started)
 We are slaves *to* tradition.
 He badly stared him *in* the face. (looked)
 They started *for* Delhi. (left)
 He is suffering *from* fever.
 You must suffer *for* your folly.
 His speech was suitable *to* the occasion.
 I want a house suitable *for* me.
 I have no sympathy *for* idlers.

T, U, V, W, X, Y, Z

Take *off* your shoes before you enter the kitchen. (remove)
 Take *down* these notes and prepare for the examination. (to record)
 He was talking *to* me about you.
 He talked *of* her success.
 He has no taste *for* music. (liking for)
 I was tired *of* waiting. (sick of)
 I am tired *with* hard work.
 He treats us *with* respect.
 He is true *to* his promise.

Trust <i>in</i> God and do the right.	(have faith)
He turned <i>down</i> my request.	(rejected)
He has turned <i>out</i> to be a false friend.	(prove)
He turned <i>up</i> late at night.	(appeared)
We are used <i>to</i> hardships.	(accustomed)
I was vexed <i>at</i> his behaviour.	(annoyed)
He is victim <i>to</i> the fury of the cyclone.	
I shall wait <i>for</i> you.	
He waited <i>upon</i> the minister, but in vain.	(waited to see)
He was warned <i>of</i> the danger.	(cautioned)

Exercises for Practice

Exercise 1

Put Suitable Prepositions in the blank spaces :

1. Mothers have affection their children.
2. We are thankful God His blessing.
3. I feel no appetite food.
4. We are tired you.
5. He has an easy access this officer.
6. He was true his principles.
7. Pay great attention English.
8. Is he unfit practical work?
9. You are vexed my behaviour.
10. I have an advantage my enemy.

Exercise 2

Put Suitable Prepositions in the blank spaces :

1. He has no confidence me.
2. Rajinder is related me.
3. We have nothing but contempt him.
4. Be respectful your parents.
5. You have no authority me in this matter.
6. He has an ambition high business.
7. Sita is very sensitive criticism.
8. I have no objection his joining this college.
9. We are short money at present.
10. I am ready tea.

Exercise 3

Put Suitable Prepositions in the blank spaces :

1. He is a disgrace his family.
2. Agra is famous its historical buildings.
3. Pt. Nehru was popular the people.
4. I have no hatred him.
5. He stands in need money.
6. His face is familiar me.
7. We are familiar the present state of trade.
8. I am grateful you the timely help.
9. Are they not partial him?
10. She is quick English.

Exercise 4

Correct the following sentences :

1. He is on bed still.
2. We pray God daily.
3. He is accused for theft.
4. He writes from a pencil.
5. We travel in train.
6. They travel by horse back.
7. He will join school on tomorrow.
8. I prefer tea for coffee.
9. He is not ashamed for his.
10. I took pity at the beggar.

Exercise 5

Correct the following sentences :

1. It has been drizzling from Monday.
2. He delivered a speech into the college hall.
3. Sweets were distributed between the boys of the class.
4. Translate this passage in English.
5. His services have been dispensed.
6. Tibet is into the north of India.
7. His sister was married with a doctor.
8. The lion was shot with the hunter by a gun.

9. He warned me on the danger.
10. Have you disposed your goods?

Exercise 6

Fill up the blanks with suitable Prepositional Phrases from the given list :

(in favour of, for want of, on the point of, for the sake of, after all, in spite of, at home in, in search of, in the light of, find fault with, instead of, on behalf of, at the mercy of, in front of, on account of)

1. My house is situated his shop.
2. I could not attend the office an urgent piece of work at home.
3. We are going to cast our vote the best candidate.
4. We gave him dinner strong opposition from a few friends.
5. I want a pen a pencil.
6. The lawyer spoke his client.
7. The project failed funds.
8. The old lady is death.
9. Lala Lajpat Rai died his country.
10. Let us forgive him;, his being merely a child.
11. He is Mathematics.
12. After the death of his father, he was left his step mother only.
13. The crow flew hither and thither some pebbles.
14. It is easy to others.
15. our previous experience with this man, we are very careful in dealing with him now.

Exercise 7

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. He came daybreak.
2. He was born 1990.
3. He will start five o' clock in the morning.
4. I met him at Moga Punjab.
5. We sat the ground.
6. The cat sprang the table.
7. He is his room.
8. He jumped the river.

Exercise 8

(i) Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

I have not heard him since he left but I've heard his accident from a friend. He has been shifted Mumbai. I learn he is plaster and is unable to move of bed. He has also been injured the head. I must visit him the B.Candy Hospital when I go Mumbai next week.

(ii) Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

India is now one the major nuclear powers of the world. The first Indian nuclear device was exploded Pokhran, a place 106 km. the town of Jaisalmer May 18, 1974. It was an underground explosion, many kilometres below the surface the earth. There was no smoke, no dreadful balls fire ; no animal or human life was destroyed the explosion a crater of about 150 metres diameter was formed.

Exercise 9

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. He will return a week.
2. He lives Hyderabad.
3. He fell the river.
4. The tree was cut this man an axe.
5. this month many famous men died.
6. He begins school today.
7. He has been sleeping morning.
8. She came a good family.

Exercise 10

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. He has been ill Friday last.
2. I shall be there 6o' clock.
3. His answer is the point.
4. being found guilty, he was imprisoned.
5. I prefer walking cycling.
6. She was fond reading novels.
7. What is the time your watch?
8. I have no use it.

Exercise 11

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. He is true his words.
2. I differ you this point.
3. I am sick idleness.
4. The train is time.
5. Do not translate word word.
6. They are very proud their success.
7. I took him his word.
8. Divide the apple two parts.
9. He congratulated me my success.
10. He deals cloth.

Exercise 12

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. We are in need money.
2. The train is time.
3. I am sick this job.
4. Do not be cruel animals.
5. He has applied leave.
6. He is quick his actions.
7. Trust God.
8. He is kind me.
9. He is no match you.
10. Cows feed grass.

Exercise 13

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. This copy is very different that.
2. Some lady is knocking the door.
3. Ritu is not suitable this post.
4. Helen is not home just now.
5. Ram comes a noble family.
6. Open your book page twelve.
7. Ranjit was seated the two girls.
8. He takes his father.

Exercise 14

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

Last week when I went home, I left my watch the drawer my brother's table and forgot all it. It was only reaching the hostel that I realised my mistake. Now I am requesting a friend mine, who is going my town, to call my brother and ask him to deliver the watch him.

Exercise 15

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. She supplied the poor food.
2. He lives milk only.
3. He was killed a highway man a dagger.
4. The Flying Mail departs 12.20 p.m for Delhi.
5. I have been here a long time.
6. She was fond reading books.
7. She sat me.
8. We met her the station.

Exercise 16

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. He walked the hall.
2. I have been suffering from fever Monday last.
3. He cut his finger a knife.
4. A quarrel arose the two sisters.
5. I shall not be there an hour.
6. He stood the crowd of boys.
7. She will come a week.
8. She died grief her lost son.

Exercise 17

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. You must take care your health.
2. He died fever.
3. He is ill malaria.
4. The basket is full flowers.
5. He invited me dinner.
6. She prays God every day.
7. He is tired this life.
8. Have pity us.

Exercise 18

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. He did not reply my letter.
2. She lives close my house.
3. He fought his enemies.
4. He complained me.
5. He borrowed money me.
6. My marriage comes next Sunday.
7. Ram is married Sita.
8. Basu depends your help.
9. Who rules England?
10. We laughed her dress.

Exercise 19

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. Turn left the traffic lights.
2. Keep the left.
3. Turn left the mall.
4. He stayed here a while.
5. I have known him a long time.
6. He died the night.
7. We will wait here he comes.
8. We arrived the town yesterday.

Exercise 20

Fill in the blanks with suitable Prepositions :

1. The boy climbed the tree.
2. Have you seen an aeroplane go ?
3. He lives close
4. I hope to see you Monday.
5. When are you going to start your journey?
6. The 9.15 train started time.
7. He will probably arrive 6.00 p.m.
8. I hired a taxi my holidays.
9. He died cholera.
10. The mother looks the child.